A Long Journey: Omar and the Sea

Day 1 · Reading (1 of 2)

What to do: Read it aloud, one paragraph each. Stop at every blue word: can anybody explain it?

Vocabulary topic: Review: princes, time, the ocean and pride
20 new words (in blue) · EEW 1, Unit 7–10 · read a story that uses the words of Units 7–10 and talk about journeys and experience



easy parts harder parts (most new words are here)

Have you ever dreamed about a long journey? Many people have. Let me tell you about a young man named Omar. He is not a real prince, but his story has everything a good adventure needs: a **challenge**, an **island** and a lot of **trouble**.

Omar has wanted to cross the sea since he was a child. His grandfather, a fisherman, taught him to sail when he was ten. Omar has never left the country, but he has read hundreds of books about the **ocean**. Last summer, he finally decided to try.

First he had to **arrange** everything. He asked the port officials, and they did not **accept** his plan at once: a boat of six meters is small for the open sea. Omar did not give up. He prepared the boat for months, and his friends helped him to **fix** the sail and to **protect** the wood from water. A **famous** sailor even sent him a letter of **encouragement**: “Keep the **balance** between courage and care.”

In July he **set off**. The first days were pleasant: the sun was shining, the waves were small, and he saw **huge** fish under the boat. Then a storm came. The wind was strong, and a big wave nearly turned the boat over. Omar was afraid, but he did what he had learned: he stayed calm and **grabbed** the rope.

After four days he saw an **island** in the distance. He did not **discover** it, of course: it was on the map. But for him it was a new world. There was a white **beach**, a few palm trees and a small **rock** where he sat for a long time. He had a feeling of deep **peace**. He has often said since that this was the most important moment of his life. Nobody **claims** that he is a hero, and he does not want it.

A Long Journey: Omar and the Sea

Day 1 · Reading (2 of 2)

What to do: After reading: which paragraphs were easy, which were hard? Which blue words did you know already?

On the island he met an old man who had lived there for forty years. They shared bread and fish. The old man asked: “Have you ever been afraid of the sea?” Omar answered: “Yes, a lot. But I have never stopped wanting to see it.”

The way home was easier, but it was not a **single** day without work. When he returned, the whole village was waiting. They did not ask, “Were you afraid?” They asked, “What have you learned?” Omar thought for a moment and said: “The **success** is not to arrive, but to start. A single **step** is the beginning of every journey. And the **difference** between a dream and a plan is only a first **chance**.”

Now Omar teaches children to sail. He has taught more than fifty so far. Some of them have already crossed a small lake, and two have won a race. When they are afraid, he tells them the same thing: “Be **proud** of your first step. The rest will come.”

Omar kept a journal on his trip. Every evening he wrote three lines: what he saw, what he did and what he learned. When he came home, he read the journal and laughed at his first fears. He says that a journal is the best map of a journey.

Many famous travelers kept journals, and today scientists use them as a source of information about the weather, the sea and the daily life of old times. A simple sentence like “Strong wind, no sun, we ate dry bread” can be a precious fact for a historian a hundred years later.

What about you? Have you ever made a plan that was bigger than you? Have you ever started something difficult? If not yet, maybe this is a good time. Write down one small step you can do today.

The 20 words

Day 1 · Vocabulary table · Topic: Review: princes, time, the ocean and pride

What to do: Book: 4000 EEW 1, Unit 7–10, pages 45, 51, 57 and 63. Copy the words you do not know into the copybook.

Word	Meaning	По-русски	Example
challenge n.	something difficult that tests you	вызов, трудная задача	Climbing a mountain is a big challenge.
famous adj.	known by many people	знаменитый	Samarkand is a famous city.
peace n.	a time without war	мир, покой	People want peace, not war.
prince n.	the son of a king or queen	принц	The prince lived in a big palace.
protect v.	keep safe from harm	защищать	A helmet protects your head.
balance n./v.	a steady position; equal parts	равновесие; удерживать	She can balance a book on her head.
familiar adj.	well known to you	знакомый	Your face looks familiar.
grab v.	take something suddenly with your hand	хватать	He grabbed his bag and ran.
huge adj.	very, very big	огромный	An elephant is a huge animal.
success n.	doing something well; getting what you wanted	успех	The concert was a big success.
beach n.	sandy or stony land next to the sea	пляж	We played volleyball on the beach.
discover v.	find or learn something for the first time	обнаруживать, открывать	She discovered a small cave.
island n.	land with water all around	остров	They live on a small island.
ocean n.	the very big sea	океан	The Pacific is the biggest ocean.
save v.	keep safe from danger; keep for later	спасать; копить	The firefighter saved the cat.
chance n.	a possibility; an opportunity	шанс, возможность	This is your last chance!
essential adj.	absolutely necessary	необходимый, важнейший	Sleep is essential for health.
guard n./v.	protect; watch over	охранник; охранять	A guard stands at the door.
proud adj.	pleased about something you or others did	гордый	My parents are proud of me.
trouble n.	difficulty or problems	беда, проблема	He is in trouble with his teacher.

More on the topic

Day 1 · Topic: Review: princes, time, the ocean and pride · more words

What to do: Choose 5 collocations to learn. Use the reserve words when a student already knows the main ones.

Collocations: words that go together

face a challenge	столкнуться с трудностью
a famous sailor	знаменитый моряк
keep the peace	сохранять мир
protect from...	защищать от...
keep a balance	сохранять баланс
a huge success	огромный успех
discover an island	открыть остров
save a life	спасти жизнь
take a chance	рискнуть
an essential part	важнейшая часть
be proud of...	гордиться...
get into trouble	попасть в беду

Phrasal verbs

set off	отправиться в путь	He set off in July.
give up	сдаться	Omar did not give up.
look up to	уважать	Children look up to him.
carry out	выполнять	They carried out the plan.
find out	узнать	He found out the way.
come back	вернуться	He came back in August.

Reserve words: for students who know the 20 already, or if you prefer another word

sail	парус; плыть	courage	смелость
storm	буря	map	карта
port	порт	captain	капитан
rope	верёвка	palm	пальма
journey	путешествие	wave	волна

What to read next · 4000 Essential English Words

This week: revise **Book 1, Units 7–10**: the word pages 44–45, 50–51, 56–57, 62–63 and the stories “The Best Prince”, “How the Sun and the Moon Were Made”, “The Starfish” and “The First Peacock”. Next: **Unit 11, “Princess Rose and the Creature”**, pages 68–73.